

Dan, Dushanth Mahendran

dushanthdan.github.io/portfolio • linkedin.com/in/dushanth-daniel-ray-mahendran
dushanthdanielray@gmail.com • +60102807656

Narrative Designer | Game Designer | Unreal Engine 5 & Unity

- Narrative Designer and Game Designer with 9 years of experience developing culturally grounded worlds, gameplay-integrated narrative systems, and implementation-focused content pipelines for PC, console, and mobile games.
 - Experienced in Unreal Engine 5 and Unity production workflows, including quest and dialogue systems implementation, cinematic scripting, onboarding UX, localisation coordination, and cross-disciplinary development across multi-language productions.
 - Currently working on Ondeh Ondeh and No Straight Roads 2 for PC and consoles.
-

SKILLS

Narrative & Worldbuilding Design

- Reactive Narrative Design • Quest Design • Dialogue Systems • RPG Systems • Narrative Flow Design • Branching Storytelling • Environmental Storytelling • Worldbuilding Documentation

Technical Implementation & Tools

- Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints) • Unity (C#) • Narrative Scripting (Twine, Ink, YarnSpinner, Articy Draft) • Quest & Dialogue Integration • Cinematic Integration • UI/UX Text Design

Production & Project Management

- Cross-Disciplinary Development • Agile Production • Localisation Coordination (15+ Languages) • Voice Direction • Live-Service Content Pipelines • Documentation & Onboarding Support

Tools

- Jenkins • Bitbucket • GitHub • SourceTree • TortoiseSVN • Jira • Trello • Notion • Obsidian • GoodDay
-

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Metronomik – Award-winning independent studio specializing in music-centric games.

Narrative Designer (October 2023 - Present)

Sole narrative designer for two upcoming Unreal Engine 5 titles, working directly with studio co-founders and cross-functional teams to build distinctive worlds inspired by Southeast Asian culture and music.

Production Pipeline & Narrative Implementation:

- Designed and implemented dialogue systems, reactive NPC barks, and cinematic sequences directly in Unreal Engine 5 using Blueprints, and owned UI, gameplay, and cinematic content to maintain narrative cohesion and player readability.
- Managed large-scale narrative coordination across internal/external teams, directing voice actors, audio engineers, and localisation pipelines for 11+ languages.

[Upcoming] Ondeh Ondeh (3D puzzle adventure for PC and consoles):

- Researched and adapted Southeast Asian cultural influences into gameplay and narrative systems.
- Collaborated with programmers and designers to seamlessly integrate cultural lore into the world.

[Upcoming] No Straight Roads 2 (3D action adventure for PC and consoles):

- Wrote and implemented cinematic scripts and dynamic NPC dialogue.
- Collaborated closely with gameplay designers, audio engineers, and animators to synchronise narrative pacing with rhythm-driven gameplay mechanics.

Kurechii – Award-winning independent studio focused on unique character-driven games.

Freelance Narrative Designer (January 2023 - October 2023)

Narrative Designer and Game Writer (January 2019 - November 2022)

Served as the lead narrative designer for two globally shipped titles and as a foundational worldbuilder for the studio's shared universe, collaborating directly with the Director and cross-functional teams.

Prism Universe (World Architecture):

- Architected the foundational lore and world framework for Kurechii's shared universe spanning multiple shipped titles.
- Developed the foundational lore, faction structures, and narrative framework for Kurechii's shared universe across multiple shipped titles.

Postknight 2 (Mobile):

- Led quest and narrative implementation across 120+ characters, 250+ items, and 125+ quests in collaboration with art and engineering teams.
- Edited live-ops content produced by junior writers and coordinated localisation for 8 languages.

King's League II (Apple Arcade, PC, and Mobile):

- Wrote and designed three distinct 9-hour branching story campaigns featuring non-linear narrative design.
- Managed large-scale narrative production by providing voice direction and coordinating localisation across 15 languages.

Community Scaling:

- Built the official studio Discord server to over 10,000 members in under a year, achieving a 44.6% Week 1 retention rate and securing official Discord Partner status within the first 3 months of going live.

Weyrdworks – Award-winning studio known for eccentric, experimental experiences.

Game Designer and Writer (October 2017 - November 2018)

Served as the core writer and game designer for the mobile title *WarPods*, collaborating directly with the studio founders to build the game from concept to global launch.

WarPods (Mobile):

- Authored comprehensive background lore for all in-game characters and wrote/implemented dialogue scripts for the onboarding tutorial and subsequent level campaigns.
- Owned the level design pipeline, successfully balancing character stats and combat mechanics through iterative playtesting and community feedback.

Gameka – Mobile gamification and software development company.

Lead Game Designer, Game Design Intern (May 2017 - September 2017)

- Directed cross-functional tech and art teams to design, gamify, and implement interactive applications with Unity for multiple clients.

EDUCATION

KDU UNIVERSITY

- Bachelor of Game Development (Hons) | September 2014 - July 2017

DIGIPEN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, REDMOND

- Bachelor of Arts in Game Design (Transferred to KDU) | September 2013 - July 2014